

Adding Subscription Roles (RBAC)



Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
Status:	Final	Effective:	10/30/2023

1. Purpose

To provide instructions on how to provide access to an Azure subscription using Roles Based Access Control (RBAC).

This document is not intended to cover all aspects of RBAC. It covers the most common basic needs.

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3. Instructions

3.1. Getting Started

- Azure RBAC is a separate system from Entra ID roles. Azure RBAC roles only affect Azure subscriptions.
- Although Entra ID roles do not directly affect Azure subscriptions, a user will need at least the Entra ID “Directory Reader” role to assign access to other users.
- The user must have the Azure RBAC “Owner” role to the subscription to provide access to that subscription.

3.2. Built In Roles

There are many built in Azure RBAC roles that can be assigned to a user. The full list may be found at: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/role-based-access-control/built-in-roles>

In addition to built-in roles, custom roles may be created to provide more granular access controls.

Some of the more common roles used include:

- **Owner** – this role can be thought of as the “global administrator” or “super user” for a subscription. This user can do anything in the subscription including giving other users access to the subscription.
- **Contributor** – the same as “Owner” expect this user cannot give access to other users.
- **Reader** – this user can view all resources in the subscription but cannot make any changes to resources.
- **Cost Management Reader** – can see Microsoft Cost Management data but has no other access to the subscription.
- **Cost Management Contributor** – the same as “Cost Management Reader” but can also set budgets.

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3.3. Setting Permissions for a User

Note: The following steps must be done by a user who has the “Owner” role to the subscription.

- Log into the [Azure Portal](#).
- Navigate to the [Subscriptions blade](#) and locate the subscription to which you will provide access. Confirm you have the “Owner” role.

Subscription name ↑↓	Subscription ID ↑↓	My role ↑↓
[Subscription Name]	a19ec555-[Subscription ID]	Owner

- Click on the subscription name to enter the subscription.
- On the menu, click on Access control (IAM) then click on Role assignments if you want to see the current assignments.

- Click on +Add then “Add role assignment” to add a role to another user.

- Under Role, select the appropriate role for the individual either from the “Job function roles” or “Privileged administrator roles” list.

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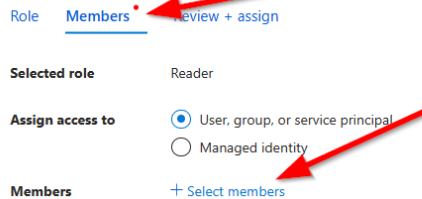


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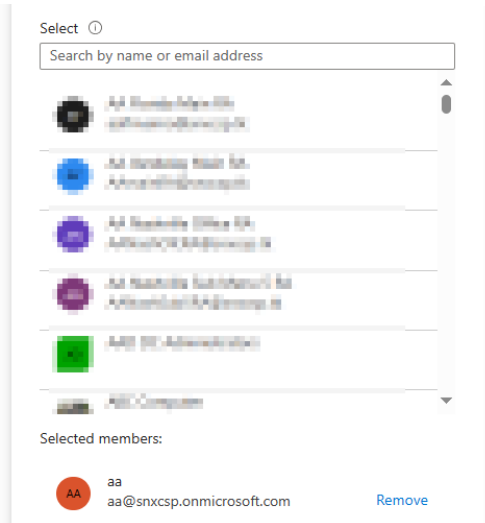
Note: Best practices suggest giving the list privileged role needed to perform the job.

- Click on “Members” then “+Select Members” to find the user in the list provided.

Add role assignment

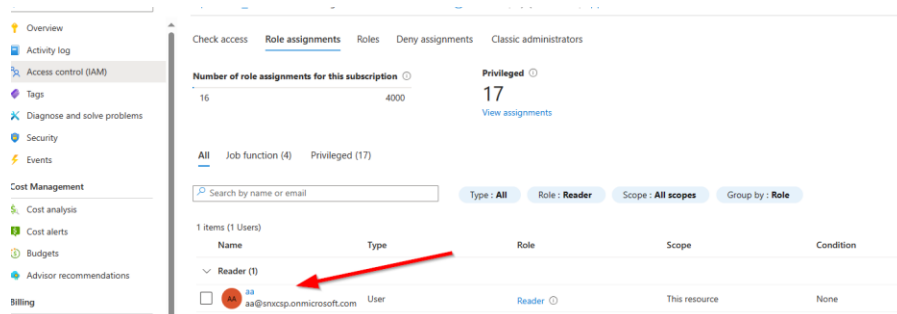


- Select users from the list then click Select at the bottom of the list



Note: The users must exist in Entra ID before they can be selected.

- After the users are selected, click “Review + assign” to give the permissions to the user.
- The assignment will show up under “Role Assignment” on the Access Control (IAM) blade.



4. Associated Documents

- [What is Azure role-based access control \(Azure RBAC\)? | Microsoft Learn](#)

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- [What is Azure attribute-based access control \(Azure ABAC\)? | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Azure built-in roles - Azure RBAC | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Azure custom roles - Azure RBAC | Microsoft Learn](#)

5. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

6. Document Revision History

<i>Number</i>	<i>Effective Date</i>	<i>Revision History</i>	<i>Author</i>
1.0	10/20/23	Initial Draft	David Bloom